The Ising perceptron at nonzero margin: certified bounds along the capacity curve

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November 2026

Abstract

The storage capacity of the Ising perceptron at margin κ is predicted by a replica-symmetric variational problem. Huang proved that the predicted threshold $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ is an upper bound at every margin, provided four numerical hypotheses on explicit low-dimensional problems hold at that margin. We verify the four hypotheses in ball arithmetic at the margins $\kappa = -0.45$, -0.05, 0.05, 0.0995 and 0.13, so the upper bound holds there without conditions; for instance at $\kappa = 0.05$ the capacity is at most $\alpha_\star(0.05)$, which lies in $[0.781073068, 0.781074776]$. Three of the hypotheses are verified on the whole strip $\kappa \in [-0.65, 0.19]$. At $\kappa \neq 0$ the fixed-point parameters are known only to boxes about 10^5 times wider than at zero margin, and the zero-margin certificate of the two-variable hypothesis fails at that width; it is restored by keeping the maximizer symbolic and by evaluating each Bregman gap of the dual localization as one integrand. The matching lower bound at $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ is not proved here.

Keywords: binary perceptron, storage capacity, replica-symmetric formula, computer-assisted proof, ball arithmetic.
2020 Mathematics Subject Classification: 82B44, 60G15, 65G30.

1 Introduction

Store $m = \alpha N$ random patterns in a linear classifier with binary weights: for i.i.d. standard Gaussian vectors $g_1, \dots, g_m$ in $\mathbb{R}^N$ and a margin $\kappa \in \mathbb{R}$, ask whether some $w \in \{-1, +1\}^N$ satisfies

$$\frac{\langle g_a, w \rangle}{\sqrt{N}} \;\geq\; \kappa \qquad \text{for all } a \leq m.$$

Krauth and Mézard [1] computed the replica-symmetric prediction for the largest such α and conjectured it sharp; at $\kappa = 0$ their constant is $\alpha_\star = 0.8330786\ldots$, in the margin framework of Gardner and Derrida [3]. Rigorous bounds at zero margin go back to Kim and Roche [4] and Talagrand [5], who proved that the capacity is at most $1 - \varepsilon$ for some $\varepsilon > 0$; Altschuler and Tikhomirov [12] give a complete proof of the bound 0.847 outlined by Krauth and Mézard. Three decades later the zero-margin conjecture was resolved: Ding and Sun [9] proved the lower bound and Huang [10] the upper bound. Both proofs are conditional on numerical hypotheses about explicit low-dimensional variational problems, and those hypotheses are verified in interval arithmetic in [14], at $\kappa = 0$.

Huang's upper-bound theorem, however, is stated at every margin. For each κ it bounds the capacity by $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$, the root of the replica-symmetric free energy along its fixed-point branch, conditionally on four numerical hypotheses at that margin. The first asks that the fixed-point equations have a unique solution, along which the free energy changes sign. The second asks that the associated approximate-message-passing iteration be stable at that solution. The third asks that an explicit function of one real variable, which controls the concavity of the first-moment functional near its maximizer, take a negative value at some point. The fourth asks that a function $\mathcal{S}_\star$ of two real variables be nonpositive on the whole plane (Conditions 1–4 of Section 2). Stojnic's fully-lifted random duality theory [22] predicts the same replica-symmetric values at every margin by nonrigorous means. We verify all four hypotheses at five nonzero margins.

Main Theorem (Theorem 4)**.** *For $\kappa \in \{-0.45,\ -0.05,\ 0.05,\ 0.0995,\ 0.13\}$ the four hypotheses of Huang's theorem hold, and the threshold $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ lies in the interval*

$$\begin{aligned} &\kappa = -0.45: \ [1.557652103,\ 1.557654133], \quad \kappa = -0.05: \ [0.889408031,\ 0.889409783],\\ &\kappa = 0.05: \ [0.781073068,\ 0.781074776], \quad \kappa = 0.0995: \ [0.733478513,\ 0.733480205],\\ &\kappa = 0.13: \ [0.705932217,\ 0.705933898]. \end{aligned}$$

For α above that interval, with probability $1 - o(1)$ as $N \to \infty$ no $w \in \{-1, +1\}^N$ satisfies all $\lceil \alpha N \rceil$ constraints.

At $\kappa = 0$ the four conditions are verified in [14]. There the fixed point is located in a rectangle of width 10^{-9}, so the maximizer $a^\star = (\psi_0(1 - q_0), q_0)$ of the two-variable problem can be treated as an exact point. For $\kappa \neq 0$ the fixed-point parameters are known only to boxes of width up to $1.9 \cdot 10^{-4}$ in ψ_0 (at $\kappa = 0.05$). The dual localization in the proof of Condition 4 needs the signs of Bregman gaps $\Phi(\lambda) - \Phi(\lambda') - (\lambda - \lambda') \cdot x$ of order 10^{-7}, where $\Phi(b) = \mathbb{E} \log 2\cosh(b_1 \dot{H} + b_2 M)$ with $\dot{H} \sim N(0, \psi_0)$ and $M = \tanh \dot{H}$, while a box of that width enters each value of Φ at about $2 \cdot 10^{-5}$. The argument of [14] therefore does not apply as written. It applies after two changes. First, the maximizer is never stored as a number: the identity $\nabla\Phi(1, 0) = (\psi_0(1 - q_0), q_0)$ gives it, and the optimal tilt $\sqrt{1 - q_0}$, as functions of the parameter balls. Second, each Bregman gap is written against the point $b_0 = (1, 0)$, where its integrand is

$$\log\bigl(\cosh \Delta + M \sinh \Delta\bigr) - M\Delta, \qquad \Delta = (\lambda_1 - 1)\dot{H} + \lambda_2 M,$$

so that the width of the box enters only at second order in $|\lambda - b_0|$. With these two changes, bounds on the inverse Mills ratio for the far-tail kernels (Lemma 3) and the formula for $\partial R/\partial q$ (Lemma 2), the four certificates of [14] hold at $\kappa = -0.45$, -0.05, 0.05, 0.0995 and 0.13 (Sections 5.2 and 6).

Conditions 1–3 hold on the whole strip $\kappa \in [-0.65, 0.19]$, on 1680 contiguous slabs of width $5 \cdot 10^{-4}$ (Section 4 and Theorem 5). Uniqueness of the fixed point comes from a contraction bound on each slab, and on $(0.10, 0.19]$ also from Nakajima's uniqueness theorem [13], whose premise is verified in ball arithmetic. The Hessian of Huang's first-moment functional at its maximizer is negative definite at six margins (Section 5.1).

The two identities of Section 2.1 are known in substance. Lemma 1 is the computation of Ding and Sun [9, Lemma 7.1 and Corollary 7.2] carried out off the fixed-point branch, and Lemma 2 is Nakajima's formula [13, eq. (18)], rewritten for R; Nakajima states it for $\kappa \geq 0$, and the computation holds for every κ.

The matching lower bound at $\kappa \neq 0$ is not proved here. Section 8 gives a lower bound for every $\kappa < 0$ by embedding a symmetric perceptron, but it lies far below $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$. The ball-arithmetic special functions, the quadrature and the serialization are those of [14], and at $\kappa = 0$ the computations of this paper reproduce the values certified there.

Section 2 states the replica-symmetric system, Huang's four conditions and the two identities. Section 3 describes the capacity curve in floating point. Section 4 proves Conditions 1–3 on the strip, and Section 5 treats the two-variable function and its Hessian. Section 6 proves Condition 4 at the five margins and states Theorems 4 and 5; Section 7 records the further margins and the passage from points to intervals. Section 8 concerns the lower bound, Section 9 the checks on the computation, Section 10 the reading of the curve for learning, and Section 11 further directions. The notation is collected at the end.

2 The system and the four hypotheses

Let φ and Ψ denote the standard Gaussian density and upper tail, $E = \varphi/\Psi$ the inverse Mills ratio (an increasing function; $E' = E\,(E-u) \in (0,1)$, proved with its second-derivative bounds in Lemma 3), and $Z \sim N(0,1)$. Fix $\kappa \in \mathbb{R}$ and write

$$u(z;q,\kappa) = \frac{\kappa - \sqrt{q}\,z}{\sqrt{1-q}}, \qquad 0 < q < 1.$$

Following Ding–Sun and Huang, the replica-symmetric system is

$$P(\psi) = \mathbb{E}\big[\tanh^2(\sqrt{\psi}\,Z)\big], \qquad R(q,\alpha) = \frac{\alpha}{1-q}\,\mathbb{E}\big[E(u(Z))^2\big], \tag{1}$$

$$G(\alpha,q,\psi) = -\frac{\psi(1-q)}{2} + \mathbb{E}\log\big(2\cosh(\sqrt{\psi}\,Z)\big) + \alpha\,\mathbb{E}\log\Psi\big(u(Z)\big), \tag{2}$$

with the fixed-point branch $q = P(\psi)$, $\psi = R(q,\alpha)$ and the threshold $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ defined as the zero of $G_\star(\alpha) = G(\alpha, q_\star(\alpha), \psi_\star(\alpha))$; we write $(q_0,\psi_0) = (q_\star,\psi_\star)(\alpha_\star(\kappa))$. At $\kappa = 0$, where $u = -\gamma z$ in law with $\gamma = \sqrt{q/(1-q)}$, this is the zero-margin system of [14]. (Display (14) of [10] has $-\alpha\,\mathbb{E}\log\Psi$; the fixed-point equations require the plus sign, which is the sign in [9, eq. (4)].)

Huang's theorem [10, Theorem 3.6] bounds the capacity at margin κ by $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ subject to four numerical hypotheses, which we state in the form his proof uses; Conditions 1, 2, 3 and 4 below are his Conditions 3.1, 3.3, 3.4 and 1.3.

Condition 1 (fixed point)**.** *On a stated rectangle, $q \mapsto P(R(q,\alpha))$ has a unique fixed point for every α in a stated interval, with $\sup_{q\in(q_{\mathrm{lb}},q_{\mathrm{ub}})}(P\circ R_\alpha)'(q) < 1$ uniformly on the rectangle, and $G_\star$ crosses zero inside that interval. The rectangle is existentially quantified: Huang's own $\kappa = 0$ instantiation (his Proposition 3.2) takes an interval of width 10^{-9} about the fixed point.*

Condition 2 (approximate message passing, AMP)**.** $\alpha\,\mathbb{E}[\mathrm{sech}^4(\sqrt{\psi_0}Z)]\;\mathbb{E}[E'(u(Z;q_0,\kappa))^2]/(1-q_0)^2 < 1$ *at the fixed point, with $u(z;q,\kappa) = (\kappa - \sqrt{q}\,z)/\sqrt{1-q}$ as above.*

Condition 3 (local concavity)**.** $\ell(z) < 0$ *for some $z > -1$, where ℓ is the function of [10, Condition 3.4], written in Section 4.1 in the form used here; a single witness suffices.*

Condition 4 (two-variable function)**.** $\mathcal{S}_\star(\lambda_1,\lambda_2) \le 0$ *for all $(\lambda_1,\lambda_2) \in \mathbb{R}^2$, where $\mathcal{S}_\star$ is the two-variable function of Section 5.2; equality holds at $(1,0)$.*

2.1 Two identities

The function G is that of Ding and Sun [9, eq. (4)], who define it at general margin; the two lemmas below record its partial derivatives and the derivative of R at every κ.

Lemma 1 (stationarity)**.** *For all $\alpha > 0$, $\kappa \in \mathbb{R}$, $\psi > 0$ and $0 < q < 1$,*

$$\frac{\partial G}{\partial \psi} = \frac{q - P(\psi)}{2}, \qquad \frac{\partial G}{\partial q} = \frac{\psi - R(q,\alpha)}{2}.$$

In particular the critical points of G are exactly the solutions of Ding and Sun's fixed-point system $q = P(\psi)$, $\psi = R(q,\alpha)$ [9], at every margin.

Proof of Lemma 1. The first identity is Gaussian integration by parts on the $\log\cosh$ term. For the second, differentiating u in q gives

$$u_q = \frac{1}{2\sqrt{1-q}}\Big(-\frac{z}{\sqrt{q}} + \frac{u}{\sqrt{1-q}}\Big), \qquad \frac{\partial}{\partial q}\,\mathbb{E}\log\Psi(u) = -\mathbb{E}\big[E(u)\,u_q\big].$$

Stein's lemma applied to the z part, $\mathbb{E}[zE(u)] = -\sqrt{q/(1-q)}\;\mathbb{E}[E'(u)]$, together with the Mills identity $E'(u) = E(u)^2 - uE(u)$, collapses the two pieces:

$$\mathbb{E}[E(u)\,u_q] = \frac{\mathbb{E}[E'(u)] + \mathbb{E}[u\,E(u)]}{2(1-q)} = \frac{\mathbb{E}[E(u)^2]}{2(1-q)} = \frac{R(q,\alpha)}{2\alpha}.$$

Hence $\partial_q G = \psi/2 - \alpha \cdot R/(2\alpha) = (\psi - R)/2$. □

Both derivatives vanish exactly on the fixed-point branch. On a rectangle carrying the contraction of Condition 1 the branch $\alpha \mapsto (q_\star, \psi_\star)$ is C^1 (the implicit function theorem applies: $1 - (P \circ R_\alpha)'$ is bounded away from zero), and the envelope theorem gives $G'_\star(\alpha) = \mathbb{E}\log\Psi(u) < 0$ strictly ($\Psi < 1$ pointwise), for every κ: the root $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ is unique on the branch. This is the general-margin form of the monotonicity clause in Condition 1, and it is also what turns the located fixed-point boxes of Section 4 into certified $\alpha_\star$ intervals: a certified sign of G at a located box is a certified side of $\alpha_\star$.

Lemma 2 (derivative of R)**.** *For all $\alpha > 0$, $\kappa \in \mathbb{R}$ and $0 < q < 1$,*

$$\frac{\partial R}{\partial q} = \frac{\alpha}{(1-q)^2}\,\mathbb{E}\Big[E'(u)^2 + 2\,E(u)^2 E'(u)\Big] \;>\; 0.$$

Proof. Differentiating (1) in q produces $R/(1-q) + \frac{\alpha}{1-q}\mathbb{E}[2EE'u_q]$. Splitting u_q as in Lemma 1 and applying Stein's lemma to $\mathbb{E}[z\,EE'(u)]$ (with $(EE')' = E'^2 + EE''$ and $E'' = E'(E-u) + EE' - E$) turns the cross term into

$$\mathbb{E}[2EE'u_q] = \frac{\mathbb{E}[E'^2 + 2E^2E' - E^2]}{1-q},$$

and the $-\alpha\mathbb{E}[E^2]/(1-q)^2$ piece cancels $R/(1-q)$ exactly. Positivity is immediate since $E' \in (0,1)$. In both proofs differentiation under the integral sign is dominated ($|z\tanh(\sqrt{\psi}z)| \le \sqrt{\psi}\,z^2$, and the q-integrands grow at most quadratically in $|z|$, locally uniformly in the parameters), and Stein's lemma applies because $E(u(z))$ and $(EE')(u(z))$ are absolutely continuous with bounded derivative in z. □

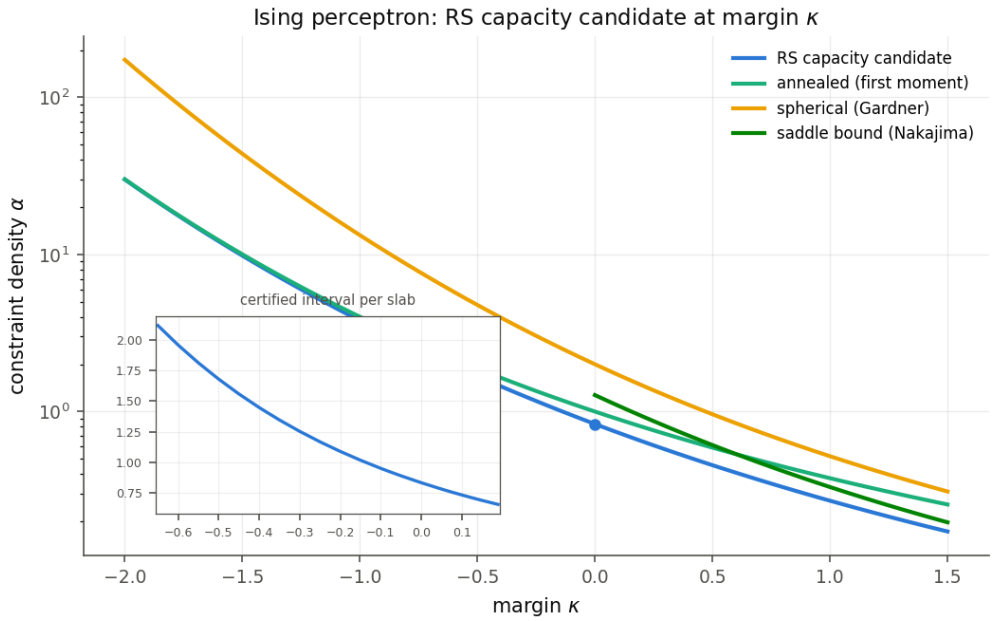


Figure 1: The replica-symmetric threshold $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ (warm-started continuation from the certified value at $\kappa = 0$), the annealed bound $\log 2/(-\log \Psi(\kappa))$, the Gardner spherical capacity [2], and Nakajima's saddle-existence bound $\alpha_c(\kappa) = 2/(\pi\, \mathbb{E}[(\kappa - Z)_+^2])$ for $\kappa \geq 0$. The inset shows the certified per-slab $\alpha_\star$ intervals on the strip.

Lemma 1 is the computation of Ding and Sun [9, Lemma 7.1 and Corollary 7.2] carried out off the fixed-point branch. Lemma 2 is Nakajima's formula [13, eq. (18)]: with $B(q) = (1-q)\mathbb{E}[E(u)^2]$ one has $R = \alpha B(q)/(1-q)^2$, and his computation of B', stated for $\kappa \geq 0$, does not use the sign of κ. It gives at every margin the monotonicity of R that Ding and Sun prove at $\kappa = 0$ [9, Lemma 7.3]. The one-term form is used twice: the integrand is a product of quantities with classical bounds, so its interval enclosure is tight enough for the contraction certificate on each slab; and positivity makes $q \mapsto P(R(q))$ increasing, which is what the location step of Section 4 bisects on.

3 The capacity curve and the condition map

A warm-started continuation in high-precision floating point (not a certificate) follows the fixed point along $\kappa \in [-2.0, 1.5]$, recording at each of 71 points the threshold, the fixed point, the contraction $(P \circ R_\alpha)'(q_\star)$, the AMP product and the local-concavity minimum ℓ_0. Selected values:

κ	$\alpha_\star$	$q_\star$	$(P \circ R)'$	AMP	ℓ_0
-2.0	29.9921	0.11863	0.387	0.440	-0.147
-1.0	3.79463	0.36519	0.583	0.607	-0.099
-0.5	1.67884	0.47377	0.666	0.589	-0.132
0	0.83308	0.56395	0.744	0.544	-0.191
0.5	0.45566	0.63841	0.810	0.489	-0.271
1.0	0.27070	0.69988	0.863	0.433	-0.359
1.5	0.17245	0.75049	0.903	0.381	-0.442

All three per-point conditions hold at every point computed. The contraction is the only quantity trending toward failure, and only slowly; ℓ_0 approaches zero nearest $\kappa \approx -1.3$ (about -0.094) and then strengthens again. On the positive branch $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ stays below Nakajima's bound at every grid point (worst ratio 0.874 at $\kappa = 1.5$). Toward $\kappa = -2$, the lower edge of the computed range, the threshold approaches the annealed bound from below, as it must where the constraints trivialize. The optimal tilt of the two-variable functional at its maximizer matches $\sqrt{1 - q_0}$ to eight digits at every κ checked, as Huang's identity [10, Lemma 7.15] requires; the identity is used exactly in Section 6.

4 Certificates on a strip

For κ in sub-slabs of width $5 \cdot 10^{-4}$ covering $[-0.65, 0.19]$, with per-slab parameter rectangles seeded by the continuation, we verify Conditions 1–3 in ball arithmetic (`python-flint` 0.9.0 on FLINT 3.6.0, 80-bit working precision, every input a ball covering the whole slab).

4.1 Numerical architecture

The computation rests on three devices.

First, adaptive complex quadrature cannot resolve enclosure width that comes from parameter balls: subdividing the integration variable does not shrink it, and the integrator exhausts any budget. So every wide-parameter integral is a real-cell Riemann sum with exact per-cell Gaussian masses. Second, the ball evaluation of φ/Ψ fails on wide arguments in the steep region (the enclosure of Ψ crosses zero), while the ratio is monotone; all Mills-family factors are therefore enclosed by two thin endpoint evaluations, and the sign-critical sums use the mean-value cell rule (midpoint value plus a derivative correction; on a cell of width h its error is $O(h^2)$ against the plain hull's $O(h)$, with constants set by the derivative enclosures on that cell). Third, expectations that nearly cancel must be evaluated as one correlated integrand, never as separate sums whose parameter widths add. For Condition 3 this is the identity (with $\tau = E'$, $A = 1 - q_0$, and $\beta = \mu(\hat{z}) - A$ for $\mu(\hat{z}) = \mathbb{E}[(\hat{z} + \cosh^2(\sqrt{\psi_0} Z))^{-1}]$)

$$\ell(\hat{z}) = \hat{z} + \alpha \, \mathbb{E}\left[\frac{\beta \, \tau^2}{A(A + \beta\tau)} \right],$$

whose integrand is monotone in τ for fixed (μ, A), regular on all of $\tau \in [0, 1]$, and bounded by $|\beta|/(A\mu)$. The identity, the monotonicity, and the bound are verified symbolically.

4.2 Uniqueness by contraction

On each slab the checks are: (i) the contraction $\sup_q (P \circ R_\alpha)' \le \sup_\psi P' \cdot \sup_q |\partial R/\partial q| < 1$ on the slab rectangle, via Lemma 2; (ii) existence: the endpoints of the q interval map strictly inward under $P \circ R_\alpha$ on each of eight α sub-intervals; (iii) the crossing: at the two thin α endpoints a certified Picard iteration locates the fixed point (the invariant is that the image of any set containing the fixed point contains it) and the sign of G resolves through a mean-value form that keeps the stationarity cancellations of Lemma 1 explicit, $G(\alpha_{\mathrm{lb}}) > 0 > G(\alpha_{\mathrm{ub}})$; (iv) Condition 2; (v) Condition 3 at Huang's witness $\hat{z} = -0.6693$. Together with the strict decrease of $G_\star$, (i)–(iii) discharge Condition 1 verbatim on the slab: $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ exists, is unique, and lies in the slab's α interval for every κ in the slab.

The contraction bound is claimed per slab only. Over a batch hull the κ width poisons the $\partial R/\partial q$ enclosure and the product of suprema loses a factor of about two against the supremum of the product; on a single slab the identity-based enclosure clears 1 with margin 0.049 at $\kappa = 0$, growing to 0.198 at $\kappa = -0.65$ and thinning to 0.0083 at $\kappa = 0.10$.

All 1500 slabs covering $[-0.65, 0.10]$ pass every check, in forty independent runs; a collector checks that consecutive slabs share their κ boundary. The q interval of a slab must cover the drift of the fixed point across the slab's (α, κ) rectangle, which is dominated by $\partial q_\star/\partial\alpha \approx 0.92$ times the width of the α interval; the drift $dq_\star/d\kappa$ stays near 0.18 across the strip.

4.3 Uniqueness on $(0.10, 0.19]$

The product of suprema exceeds 1 near $\kappa = 0.12$, while the contraction at the fixed point stays below 0.78: at $\kappa = 0.13$ the product over the slab rectangle is 1.32, while a certified sign bisection of the displacement $P(R(q)) - q$ (which has certified signs at the interval endpoints and, by the uniqueness of the fixed point, a single zero between them, so it is positive below the fixed point and negative above) locates the fixed point at both α endpoints to width $2 \cdot 10^{-8}$ with no contraction input, the contraction evaluated on the located intervals reads 0.79, and the G crossing resolves with margins $2 \cdot 10^{-3}$.

The rectangle clause itself is then discharged at $\kappa = 0.13$ exactly as Huang's Proposition 3.2 discharges it at $\kappa = 0$: on the rectangle $\alpha \in [0.705932217, 0.705933898]$, $q \in [0.5836943, 0.5857104]$ (the located fixed points $\pm 10^{-3}$), the certified contraction product is 0.8435, the map is endpoint-inward at both α ends with margins above $2.3 \cdot 10^{-4}$, the G signs at the located fixed points are $+1.6 \cdot 10^{-7}$ and $-1.6 \cdot 10^{-6}$, and $\mathbb{E} \log \Psi < 0$ over the rectangle (`rect_cond31_0p13.json`; quadrature depth 16000). The value 1.32 comes from the width of the slab rectangle; the contraction at the fixed point $(P \circ R_\alpha)'(q_\star)$ is nearly flat, rising only from 0.758 at $\kappa = 0.10$ to 0.770 at $\kappa = 0.19$, everywhere below 1 with margin above 0.22. The rectangle clause is therefore decided by the width of the rectangle: over $(0.10, 0.19]$ (`rect_strip_nak.jsonl`, per κ sub-ball) the product is below 1 at $\kappa = 0.10$ with q half-width $2 \cdot 10^{-3}$ but exceeds it (1.012) by $\kappa = 0.15$ with the same half-width, and a thinner located rectangle brings $\kappa = 0.13$ to 0.844. The half-width is set by the located q interval, whose width comes mostly from the slab's α width ($3 \cdot 10^{-3}$) through $\partial q_\star/\partial\alpha \approx 0.9$; narrowing it means deep-locating $\alpha_\star$ per slab to $\sim 10^{-6}$, the same tightening the five point margins already carry, after which the flat contraction leaves a thin rectangle that clears 1. At $\kappa \in \{0.13, 0.15, 0.185\}$ the contraction products on such rectangles are 0.844, 0.836 and 0.830 (`rect_cond31_0p15.json`, `rect_cond31_0p185.json`). On each of the 180 slabs covering $[0.10, 0.19]$, over eight κ sub-balls of width $6.25 \cdot 10^{-5}$, the located rectangle with q half-width

$5\cdot10^{-4}$ is endpoint-inward at both α ends and carries a certified contraction product below one, the worst bound being 0.958 (`rect_strip_nak_thin_*.jsonl`, collected with the input hashes bound in `rect_strip_thin_summary.json`). With the inward endpoints and Lemma 2's monotonicity this gives, for every $\kappa \in (0.10, 0.19]$, a rectangle on which the fixed point is unique by the contraction itself, so the rectangle clause of Condition 1 holds on every slab with uniqueness carried both by the rectangle and, independently, by Nakajima's theorem.

The other checks on these 180 slabs are: existence by the same inward test; location by certified sign bisection per κ sub-ball (the κ width floors the displacement's sign resolution, so each slab runs eight sub-balls whose union covers it); the contraction consumed only on located intervals, which is the local form Huang's perturbation argument uses; and uniqueness from Nakajima's saddle theorem [13], whose premise $\alpha_{\mathrm{ub}} < \alpha_c(\kappa) = 2/(\pi\,\mathbb{E}[(\kappa - Z)_+^2])$ is certified per slab through the closed form $\mathbb{E}[(\kappa - Z)_+^2] = (1+\kappa^2)\big(1 - \Psi(\kappa)\big) + \kappa\varphi(\kappa)$ (worst certified premise margin 0.311).

On the whole strip, 1680 contiguous slabs pass and none fails. At five margins a certified bisection on the sign of G at located boxes tightens the slab intervals to width about $2 \cdot 10^{-6}$; the resulting enclosures are those of Theorem 4. Each contains its continuation value, and the slab containing $\kappa = 0$ contains the Ding–Sun constant. At the default quadrature depth the enclosure of G limits the width to $1.4 \cdot 10^{-5}$; the five intervals use a larger depth.

5 The two-variable function

This section treats the first-moment functional at its maximizer and writes Huang's two-variable function at general margin in the form the certificates of Section 6 evaluate.

5.1 The maximizer and its Hessian

The local ingredient of Condition 4 is the negative definiteness of the Hessian $\mathcal{H}$ of Huang's first-moment functional at its maximizer. His second-derivative expansion, *before* the zero-margin specialization, gives at every κ the same quadratic form

$$\langle \xi, \mathcal{H}\xi \rangle = -(I_1\xi_1^2 + 2I_2\xi_1\xi_2 + I_3\xi_2^2) + C_1 y_1^2 + C_2 y_1 y_2 + C_3 y_2^2,$$

where $y_1 = I_1\xi_1 + I_2\xi_2$ and $y_2 = I_2\xi_1 + I_3\xi_2$, with prior-side integrals I_j unchanged in form ($I_1 = \psi_0(1-q_0) - 2\psi_0^2(1 - 4q_0 + 3p_4)$, $I_2 = \psi_0(1 - 4q_0 + 3p_4)$, $I_3 = q_0 - p_4$, $p_4 = \mathbb{E}\tanh^4(\sqrt{\psi_0}Z)$) and constraint-side constants C_j that at $\kappa \neq 0$ must be taken from the pre-specialization display: his zero-margin closed forms rest on two identities of the unshifted law, of which $\alpha\,\mathbb{E}[\eta^2] = \psi_0$ survives at every margin (it is the same identity behind the unbounded-tilt directions of Section 5.2) while $\alpha\,\mathbb{E}[\eta\hat{H}] = -q_0(1-q_0)\psi_0$ does not. We evaluate the general-margin C_j directly at the shifted law. With $\hat{H} = \sqrt{q_0}\,Z$, $u = (\kappa - \hat{H})/\sqrt{1-q_0}$, $\eta = E(u)/\sqrt{1-q_0}$, $F' = -E'(u)/(1-q_0)$, and $Q = -\hat{H}/q_0 + \big(\kappa - \hat{H} - (1-q_0)\eta\big)/(1-q_0)$, every expectation over the single Gaussian $\hat{H}$,

$$C_1 = \frac{\alpha}{\psi_0^2}\,\mathbb{E}[F'\eta^2], \qquad C_2 = -\frac{2\alpha}{\psi_0}\,\mathbb{E}[F'\eta Q] + \frac{2}{1-q_0},$$

$$C_3 = \alpha\,\mathbb{E}[F'Q^2] + \frac{2\alpha}{q_0(1-q_0)}\,\mathbb{E}[\eta\hat{H}] - \alpha\Big(\frac{3}{(1-q_0)^2} + \frac{1}{q_0(1-q_0)}\Big)\mathbb{E}\big[\eta\,(\kappa - \hat{H} - (1-q_0)\eta)\big].$$

The certified evaluation encloses each expectation by the mean-value cell rule with explicit quadratic tail majorants (η grows at most linearly on the left tail, F' is bounded by $1/(1-q_0)$ in magnitude, and every integrand is degree at most two in $|z|$), and the near-cancelling prior moments are evaluated as single correlated integrands. The certified enclosures at the six margins are one-sided where sign is the claim:

$$\begin{aligned}
\kappa = -0.45: &\quad \mathcal{H}_{11} \le -0.0647, \quad \det\mathcal{H} \ge 2.9\cdot 10^{-4},\\
\kappa = -0.05: &\quad \mathcal{H}_{11} \le -0.0471, \quad \det\mathcal{H} \ge 1.6\cdot 10^{-4},\\
\kappa = 0: &\quad \mathcal{H}_{11} \le -0.0451, \quad \det\mathcal{H} \ge 1.8\cdot 10^{-4},\\
\kappa = 0.05: &\quad \mathcal{H}_{11} \le -0.0424, \quad \det\mathcal{H} \ge 1.2\cdot 10^{-4},\\
\kappa = 0.0995: &\quad \mathcal{H}_{11} \le -0.0400, \quad \det\mathcal{H} \ge 1.0\cdot 10^{-4},\\
\kappa = 0.13: &\quad \mathcal{H}_{11} \le -0.0385, \quad \det\mathcal{H} \ge 8.8\cdot 10^{-5},
\end{aligned}$$

The bound on $|\mathcal{H}_{11}|$ decreases as κ increases.

Certification requires parameter boxes far tighter than the slabs provide ($\det\mathcal{H} \sim 10^{-4}$ moves at order $dC/dq \sim 10$), which is what the deep $\alpha_\star$ intervals above are for. On the resulting located boxes ($3.6\cdot 10^{-6}$ in q_0, $5.2\cdot 10^{-5}$ in ψ_0 at $\kappa = 0.05$) the certificate resolves: $\mathcal{H}_{11} < 0$ and $\det\mathcal{H} > 0$ in ball arithmetic, with the near-cancellations $1-4q_0+3p_4$ and q_0-p_4 evaluated as single correlated integrands and the five constraint-side integrals by mean-value Riemann sums with elementary Mills-family derivatives. The same chain certifies at $\kappa = 0$ on the Ding–Sun rectangle, where the C_j enclosures lie inside Huang's certified intervals, and at -0.05, 0.0995, -0.45 (where $C_1 = -0.855$, against -0.718 at zero margin) and 0.13.

Along the continuation the fixed-tilt $\mathcal{H}$ stays negative definite up to $\kappa = 1.15$ and loses definiteness inside $(1.1812, 1.1844)$, while the Hessian of the tilt-optimized functional remains negative out to at least $\kappa = 1.5$; the two are consistent by the Schur relation (the fixed-tilt form dominates), so past $\kappa \approx 1.18$ a local argument must re-optimize the tilt, as the ray certificates below already do.

5.2 The function at general margin

Huang's two-variable function at margin κ, in the form his proof uses, is

$$\mathcal{S}(\Lambda, s) = \frac{s^2\psi_0}{2} + \mathrm{ent}(\Lambda) + \alpha\,\mathbb{E}\log\Psi\left(\frac{\kappa - (a_2/q_0)\hat{H} - (a_1/\psi_0)\eta}{D} + s\eta\right),$$

where $\dot{H} \sim N(0,\psi_0)$ and $\hat{H} \sim N(0,q_0)$ are independent, $M = \tanh\dot{H}$ (Huang's notation), $\eta = F_{1-q_0}(\hat{H}) = E\big((\kappa-\hat{H})/\sqrt{1-q_0}\big)/\sqrt{1-q_0}$ is the shifted cavity law (this is one of the two places the margin enters; the other is the additive κ in the $\log\Psi$ argument), $a_1 = \mathbb{E}[\dot{H}\Lambda]$, $a_2 = \mathbb{E}[M\Lambda]$, $D = \sqrt{1-a_2^2/q_0}$, and $\mathcal{S}_\star(\lambda_1,\lambda_2) = \inf_{s\ge 0}\mathcal{S}(\tanh(\lambda_1\dot{H}+\lambda_2 M), s)$. Condition 4 asks $\mathcal{S}_\star \le 0$ everywhere.

The zero-margin verification's reduction applies verbatim: the profile enters only through the moment pair (a_1, a_2), which ranges over a compact convex body K (the moment body of $(\dot{H}, M)$), and on K the entropy term is bounded by convex duality, $H(a) \le \Phi(b) - b\cdot a$ for every dual point b, with $\Phi(b) = \mathbb{E}\log 2\cosh(b_1\dot{H} + b_2 M)$ free of κ. The margin lives entirely in the constraint term. Two structural facts organize the verification. The maximizer sits at $a^\star = (\psi_0(1-q_0), q_0)$ for every κ: this is the base-point identity $\nabla\Phi(1,0) = (\mathbb{E}[\dot{H}M], \mathbb{E}[M^2]) = (\psi_0(1-q_0), q_0)$ (Gaussian integration by parts and the fixed-point equations), and [10, Lemma 7.15] gives $\mathcal{S}_\star = 0$ there with optimal tilt $s_0 = \sqrt{1-q_0}$, both in closed

form. And on roughly the half-plane $\lambda_1 < 0$ the s-infimum is genuinely $-\infty$: $\alpha\,\mathbb{E}[\eta^2] = \psi_0$ exactly at the fixed point, so the quadratic tilt coefficient cancels, and wherever the surviving linear coefficient of the tilt is nonpositive the functional runs away (the measured boundary of that region at $\kappa = 0.05$ crosses $\lambda_1 = 0.04$ on the $\lambda_2 = 0$ axis and bends left as $|\lambda_2|$ grows). No certificate uses this observation: the condition asks for the uncapped infimum over $s \geq 0$, so a certified negative value at one explicit finite tilt (which is what the Region II certificates exhibit cell by cell) is already a complete witness, and the runaway directions are the capped-tilt case handled inside Huang's own argument.

Float diagnostics along the curve (the certified analogue follows) show a function essentially independent of κ: a single peak at $(1, 0)$, off-center values below $-3 \cdot 10^{-3}$, negative far rays, Hessian eigenvalues near $(-0.22, -0.0045)$, and moment-body clearance near 0.017, with the weak eigenvalue degrading toward deep negative margin (-0.0013 at $\kappa = -1.5$), the measured approach to the expected replica-symmetry-breaking territory.

6 Certifying the two-variable condition

The zero-margin certificate has four pieces: a sweep of the moment body outside an exclusion box around $a^\star$ (Region II), banded ray-concavity certificates on a star around $a^\star$ (Region I), a second sweep of the exclusion box minus the star (stage 2), and an interior-ball certificate placing the star strictly inside the moment body. At $\kappa \neq 0$ all four meet the same difficulty. At zero margin the parameters (q_0, ψ_0) are certified to a rectangle of width 10^{-9}, so the maximizer's coordinates can be stored as decimals and every enclosure treats them as exact; at $\kappa = 0.05$ the located boxes have width up to $1.9 \cdot 10^{-4}$ in ψ_0, and that width enters every plain evaluation of Φ at about $2 \cdot 10^{-5}$, much wider than the Bregman gaps of order 10^{-7} in the dual localization. Three identities and bounds make the four certificates apply.

The symbolic maximizer. Every certificate that references $a^\star$ or the base tilt s_0 uses them as the parameter balls ($\psi_0(1 - q_0)$, q_0) and $\sqrt{1 - q_0}$, never as stored decimals, so the true maximizer, at the true parameters, is covered exactly and the ray identities ($\mathcal{S} = 0$, $\nabla\mathcal{S} = 0$, tilt optimality at the true $a^\star$) hold on the certified rays with no origin-inflation ball. Ray coverage is exact: certificates evaluated over the origin ball cover in particular the rays from the true origin.

The ray argument. For a unit direction v and a slope $c \in \mathbb{R}$ put $\chi_{v,c}(t) = \mathcal{F}(a^\star + tv,\, s_0 + ct)$, where $\mathcal{F}(a, s)$ is the moment-coordinate form of $\mathcal{S}(\cdot, s)$ that the certificates evaluate, so that $\mathcal{S}_\star(a^\star + tv) \leq \chi_{v,c}(t)$ whenever $s_0 + ct \geq 0$. At the true parameters $\chi_{v,c}(0) = \chi'_{v,c}(0) = 0$ for every c, by the value, gradient and tilt identities at $a^\star$. If $\chi''_{v,c} \leq 0$ on $[0, T(v)]$ then $\chi_{v,c} \leq 0$ there, hence $\mathcal{S}_\star \leq 0$ on the segment. The chain needs one slope per ray: the second-derivative bound on a radial band $[t_0, t_1]$ with $t_0 > 0$ says nothing about χ itself unless χ and χ' are controlled at t_0, and those are controlled only through the same function on $[0, t_0]$. The certificates therefore fix the slope by direction alone: the circle is cut into 768 equal sectors, each sector carries one slope (the optimal tilt slope at its midpoint, rounded to six decimals, recorded in the manifest), every angular cell of every radial band lies inside one sector and uses that sector's slope, and a direction on a sector edge is covered by the cells of either neighbor, each with its own fixed slope. The checker recomputes each cell's sector from its angles, confirms that the cells of each band tile its angle range, and confirms the slope table is the same in the main and supplementary manifests.

The correlated Bregman evaluator. The dual localization (the argument that the dual

maximizer $\lambda(x)$ stays inside a certified box, so that the entropy Hessian can be bounded there) needs signs of Bregman gaps $\Phi(\lambda) - \Phi(\hat{\lambda}_k) - (\lambda - \hat{\lambda}_k) \cdot x$ with $x = a^\star + \text{offset}$. Evaluated as differences of plain Φ enclosures these carry the full parameter fuzz twice. Written against the anchor $b_0 = (1, 0)$, the integrand collapses exactly: with $\Delta = (\lambda_1 - 1)\dot{H} + \lambda_2 M$,

$$\log \frac{\cosh(\dot{H} + \Delta)}{\cosh \dot{H}} - (\lambda - b_0) \cdot \nabla_b \log 2\cosh(b \cdot (\dot{H}, M))\big|_{b_0} = \log\big(\cosh \Delta + M \sinh \Delta\big) - M\Delta,$$

because $(\lambda - b_0) \cdot \nabla h(b_0) = M\Delta$ pointwise. Every factor is a small ball with thin coefficients, so the parameter width enters only at second order in $|\lambda - b_0|$; at the box corners, where plain differences of enclosures fail, the enclosures are two orders of magnitude tighter, and at the anchor the evaluator returns the exact zero ball. Bregman gaps between arbitrary points are then differences of two anchored gaps, and the gradient term the localization needs is the same trick applied to $\nabla\Phi$: $\nabla\Phi(\lambda) - a^\star$ has the exact per-node form $(\dot{H}, M)\,(1 - M^2)\tanh\Delta/(1 + M\tanh\Delta)$.

The factor $\cosh\Delta + M\sinh\Delta$ itself has two exact evaluations with disjoint stability regimes: the cosh/sinh form is exact at $\Delta = 0$ (which the inner-band gaps of order 10^{-7} require) but subtracts two $e^{|\Delta|}$-sized balls when $M \approx \pm 1$ and $|\Delta|$ is large, where the guard against the complex logarithm's branch then fires on every subdivision; the split $e^{\Delta}(1 + M)/2 + e^{-\Delta}(1 - M)/2$ has both terms nonnegative on the real axis but carries first-order M-width near $\Delta = 0$. The evaluator branches per node at $|\Delta| = 1$; both forms are identities, so the branch affects tightness only.

Stable far-tail kernels. The ray certificates consume second derivatives of the constraint term, whose kernels involve $E'(V) = E(V)(E(V) - V)$ and $E''(V)$, with E the inverse Mills ratio of Section 2, evaluated at cavity arguments V that reach about 20 on far quadrature cells; there $E(V) - V$ is a difference of two large balls and the kernels explode (we measured certified upper bounds of $+2 \cdot 10^3$ on cells whose true ray second derivative is -6.6). The bounds of the following lemma, applied as intersections with the computed balls, remove the failure; the intersection of an enclosure with a proven bound is again an enclosure.

Lemma 3 (bounds on the inverse Mills ratio)**.** *Let E be the inverse Mills ratio and $\sigma = E - V$. For every $V \in \mathbb{R}$,*

$$\sigma > 0 \quad \Big(\textit{and } \sigma < \frac{1}{V} \textit{ for } V > 0\Big), \qquad E' = E\sigma \in (0, 1), \qquad 0 < E'' < \sigma.$$

Proof. For $V \le 0$, $\sigma > 0$ because $E > 0$. For $V > 0$ the bounds $V < E(V) < V + 1/V$ are Gordon's inequalities [7], which give $0 < \sigma < 1/V$. The bounds $0 < E' < 1$ are due to Sampford [8]; in the present notation $E' = E^2 - VE = E\sigma$, and $1 - E' = \mathrm{Var}(Z \mid Z > V)$ by the conditional moments $\mathbb{E}[Z \mid Z > V] = E$ and $\mathbb{E}[Z^2 \mid Z > V] = 1 + VE$, which are used again below. The upper bound on E'' is the identity $E'' - \sigma = (E' - 1)(E + \sigma)$ with $E' < 1$ and $E + \sigma > 0$.

Positivity of E'', the convexity of the inverse Mills ratio, is the one clause that takes an argument. Differentiating E' gives $E'' = E\,[\,\sigma(E + \sigma) - 1\,]$, and for W distributed as $Z - V$ conditioned on $\{Z > V\}$ the moment formulas above read $\mathbb{E}W = \sigma$ and $\mathbb{E}[W^2] = 1 - VE + V^2$, whence $\sigma(E + \sigma) - 1 = 2(\mathbb{E}W)^2 - \mathbb{E}[W^2]$: the claim is that this residual law has coefficient of variation below one. Its survival function is $\mathbb{P}(W > w) = \Psi(V + w)/\Psi(V) = e^{-\Gamma(w)}$ with $\Gamma(w) = \int_0^w E(V + x)\,dx$ convex, since $E' > 0$. Set $\theta = 1/\sigma$, so the rate-θ exponential has the

same mean, and $J(w) = \Gamma(w) - \theta w$. Then J is convex with $J(0) = 0$, $J'(0) = E - 1/\sigma < 0$ (this is $E\sigma = E' < 1$ again), and $J(w) \to \infty$, so $J < 0$ exactly on some interval $(0, w_0)$ and $J > 0$ past it. Hence $\mathbb{P}(W > w) - e^{-\theta w} = e^{-\theta w}(e^{-J(w)} - 1)$ is positive before w_0 and negative after, while $\int_0^\infty (\mathbb{P}(W > w) - e^{-\theta w})\, dw = \sigma - \sigma = 0$. Therefore

$$\tfrac{1}{2}\,\mathbb{E}[W^2] - \sigma^2 = \int_0^\infty w\,\big(\mathbb{P}(W > w) - e^{-\theta w}\big)\, dw = \int_0^\infty (w - w_0)\big(\mathbb{P}(W > w) - e^{-\theta w}\big)\, dw < 0,$$

the last integrand being nonpositive and not almost everywhere zero. So $\mathbb{E}[W^2] < 2(\mathbb{E}W)^2$, that is $E'' > 0$, at every real V. □

With these three devices the four pieces certify at each of the five margins. We give the counts at $\kappa = 0.05$; the other margins are in Section 7. At $\kappa = 0.05$, on the located boxes and the deep $\alpha_\star$ interval of Section 4:

(i) *Region II*: 1296 top cells over the moment rectangle minus the exclusion box, refining to 855 leaves, zero failures.

(ii) *Region I*: the banded ray-concavity certificates over the star (radius 0.012 along the weak direction), 1404 bands from the symbolic origin, zero failures; the thinnest certified band margin is $-7.5 \cdot 10^{-5}$ and the deepest $-1.6 \cdot 10^{2}$. A supplementary run over twelve further angular ranges extends the certified radius to 0.0105 on the arcs 0.14 to 0.19 radians off the weak axes (margins $-3.5 \cdot 10^{-3}$ to -1.9), which the stage-2 leaves near those arcs require.

(iii) *Stage 2*: the exclusion box minus the star, 1363 leaves, zero failures, with star containment read from the Region-I manifests themselves: a certified band covers every direction of its angular range out to the star boundary, so the certified radius is the pointwise union of the main radius and the supplementary arcs, evaluated exactly on a piecewise-constant splitting; the SHA-256 of both manifests is bound into the stage-2 artifact.

(iv) *Star interior*: the star, origin ball included, lies strictly inside the moment body: constructive inradius 0.01481 against required 0.01209.

Together: $\mathcal{S}_\star \le 0$ on the whole plane at $\kappa = 0.05$. All four of Huang's hypotheses hold there, and his theorem gives the unconditional bound.

Theorem 4. *Let* $\kappa \in \{-0.45,\ -0.05,\ 0.05,\ 0.0995,\ 0.13\}$. *Then* $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ *lies in the corresponding interval*

$$\begin{aligned}
&\alpha_\star(-0.45) \in [1.557652103,\ 1.557654133], \quad \alpha_\star(-0.05) \in [0.889408031,\ 0.889409783],\\
&\alpha_\star(0.05) \in [0.781073068,\ 0.781074776], \quad \alpha_\star(0.0995) \in [0.733478513,\ 0.733480205],\\
&\alpha_\star(0.13) \in [0.705932217,\ 0.705933898],
\end{aligned}$$

and for every α *above that interval*

$$\lim_{N\to\infty} \mathbb{P}\Big(\exists\, w \in \{-1,+1\}^N :\ \frac{\langle g_a, w\rangle}{\sqrt{N}} \ge \kappa \text{ for all } a \le \lceil \alpha N \rceil\Big) = 0.$$

The certificates of this section accept the located boxes of any slab; Section 7.1 discusses what a κ-interval version of Condition 4 would require. The other three conditions hold on the whole strip.

κ	$\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ interval	Region II	Region I	stage 2	inradius / required
0.05	[0.781073068, 0.781074776]	855	1404 (+12)	1363	0.01481 / 0.01209
−0.45	[1.557652103, 1.557654133]	656	1404 (+12)	1196	0.01480 / 0.01207
−0.05	[0.889408031, 0.889409783]	867	1404 (+12)	1282	0.01527 / 0.01209
0.0995	[0.733478513, 0.733480205]	904	1404 (+12)	1390	0.01459 / 0.01209
0.13	[0.705932217, 0.705933898]	874	1404 (+12)	1422	0.01446 / 0.01210

Table 1: Certified leaf and band counts per piece, with zero failures in every manifest. Region I counts marked (+12) include the twelve supplementary angular ranges; under the enlarged exclusion box every margin's stage-2 lattice uses one. The final column gives the constructive moment-body inradius against the required star radius, both exact-arithmetic bounds.

Theorem 5. *(a) For every $\kappa \in [-0.65, 0.10]$, Conditions 1–3 hold, with the contraction of Condition 1 on the slab rectangle.*

(b) For every $\kappa \in (0.10, 0.19]$, Conditions 1–3 hold, with the contraction of Condition 1 on a located rectangle of q half-width $5 \cdot 10^{-4}$; uniqueness of the fixed point also follows from Nakajima's theorem [13], whose premise is verified on every slab.

(c) In both cases $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ exists, is unique on the fixed-point branch, and lies in the α interval of the slab containing κ. If Condition 4 also holds at κ, then for every α above the upper end of that interval the probability that some $w \in \{-1, +1\}^N$ satisfies all $\lceil \alpha N \rceil$ constraints at margin κ tends to 0 as $N \to \infty$.

Condition 4 holds at the five margins of Theorem 4 and, by [14], at $\kappa = 0$. At every other κ of the strip, Theorem 5(c) reduces the upper bound to Condition 4 at that κ.

7 Further margins

The four conditions of Theorem 4 are margin-wise statements, and the certificates of Sections 5.2–6 run unchanged at any κ of the strip: the program locates the (q_0, ψ_0) boxes at both endpoints of the α interval, configures the exact-arithmetic modules from those balls, and runs the same four pieces. Besides $\kappa = 0.05$ it certifies Condition 4 at $\kappa = -0.45$, -0.05, 0.0995 and 0.13. At the two negative margins the fixed-point uniqueness input comes entirely from the contraction certificates of Section 4. Table 1 lists the certified pieces at the five margins.

For each band, the Region-I manifest of every margin carries an interval matrix B with $\nabla^2\Phi(\lambda) \preceq B$ in the Loewner order (the difference is positive semidefinite) for every λ in the band's certified dual box, so that the Hessian of the entropy term is at most $-B^{-1}$ there. The Lean files check that every band's B is positive definite, in thirteen groups of 108 bands with a checked total count (55 theorems per margin; the mutation battery rejects a sign change in each group of theorems).

The stage-2 containment reads each supplement arc on both angular branches, so a cell sees every arc whichever branch its interval lies on. At $\kappa = 0.0995$ the exclusion box has upper offset +0.1030. Just above the smaller offset +0.0961 the dual certificate of Region II degenerates along a thin ridge: on a cell of width 0.0018 the certified value interval is $[\pm 0.181]$, and the bound is negative again two cell-widths higher. Enlarging the box needs no change

to Region I, because the stage-2 containment derives its tiling from the box and fails if the enlarged region leaves what the star and the supplement cover.

7.1 From points to intervals

The natural strengthening of Theorem 4 replaces each margin by a κ-interval, so that $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ becomes an unconditional bound on a continuum. For Conditions 1–3 this is what the strip certificates already provide: those inequalities hold with margins of at least $8 \cdot 10^{-3}$, and enclosing every input over a κ-slab costs less than that. Condition 4 is different.

Certifying $\mathcal{S}_\star \le 0$ over a slab means every certificate must hold with the located parameters (α, q_0, ψ_0) replaced by their hulls across the slab. Three measurements fix the scales. First, with the present locating algorithm and quadrature budget the hull widths do not shrink below a floor (the inward fixed-point test resolves no finer than the quadrature fuzz, about $3.5 \cdot 10^{-4}$ in q_0, and $\alpha_\star$ itself moves with κ: its secant slopes between the five margins are 1.67, 1.08, 0.96 and 0.90), which translate into a moment-plane origin ball of radius at least a few times 10^{-3} however narrow the slab. Second, the evaluation fuzz of every certificate grows linearly with that ball: rerunning the $\kappa = -0.65$ Region II certificate with slab-hulled parameters (ball $2.3 \cdot 10^{-2}$) inflates cell enclosures to ± 1.3, and the scaling back to the floor ball leaves ± 0.2. Third, the certificates that matter are thin: Region II's weakest certified cells at point margins sit at $-5 \cdot 10^{-4}$, and Region I's thinnest bands between $-1.1 \cdot 10^{-5}$ and $-7.5 \cdot 10^{-5}$, because the two-variable function is flat at its maximizer. With this evaluator, a certificate with margin 10^{-4} does not survive enclosure widths of order 10^{-1}, at any slab width.

The same comparison explains why the strip conditions posed no such problem. Near the maximizer the certified Hessian gives quadratic control whose constants vary slowly in κ (the fixed-tilt determinant moves by about $3.5 \cdot 10^{-4}$ per unit margin), so a κ-uniform neighborhood estimate is available from point certificates plus a crude κ-derivative bound; crude is enough, because a Lipschitz constant needs no thin margin. Far from the maximizer the certificates are fat and absorb hull fuzz directly. What remains is the intermediate annulus, where quadratic control must be extended beyond the star radius with explicit remainder bounds before the two regimes meet. That remainder bound is the missing estimate.

The certified artifacts also price that ingredient. Across the three positive margins the Region I band populations have similar margin profiles: 11, 3 and 11 bands certify below $3 \cdot 10^{-4}$ at $\kappa = 0.05$, 0.0995 and 0.13, between 55 and 66 below $3 \cdot 10^{-3}$, and 87 to 88 percent of the 1404 bands above $3 \cdot 10^{-2}$. If each band carried a certified bound L_i on the κ-derivative of its certificate value, a band would hold over a κ-radius m_i/L_i of its margin m_i, and re-certifying each band at its own pitch would cover 10^{-2} of margin axis for 1.5 to 1.9 times the cost of one point run at unit derivative bound and 2.5 to 3.8 times at a bound of three, against about $2 \cdot 10^6$ band evaluations for uniform slabs at the pitch of the thinnest band ($\kappa = 0.13$, bound three). The compute is therefore not the obstruction; what is missing is the derivative enclosure itself, one certified κ-derivative per certificate family, with the located branch differentiated implicitly. The constant itself is measurable from the existing artifacts: the band lattice is shared across margins up to the wedge rotation, and 1292 rectangles coincide exactly between the $\kappa = 0.05$ and $\kappa = 0.0995$ manifests, giving certified finite differences of each certificate value along the located branch. The median band moves at $|\Delta\mathcal{S}/\Delta\kappa| \approx 7$, and of the ten thinnest shared bands at $\kappa = 0.05$ (margins $2.2 \cdot 10^{-4}$ to $1.6 \cdot 10^{-3}$) nine move at less than 0.5 and four at less than 0.06; the thinnest of them holds over a κ-radius near $2 \cdot 10^{-4}$.

Taking the measured difference as L_i on the shared bands and the median on the others gives 3.9 runs per 10^{-2} of margin axis, about 31 Region I run-equivalents for all of $[0.05, 0.13]$. A difference over a 0.05 gap bounds the mean drift rather than the local derivative, so these numbers size the project rather than prove it; the machinery an interval theorem still requires is the certified per-certificate κ-derivative, with the same measurement then repeated for the Region II, stage-2 and interior-ball certificates.

8 Toward the matching lower bound

Write $m_N(\kappa)$ for the largest m such that some $w \in \{-1,+1\}^N$ satisfies $\langle g_a, w\rangle/\sqrt{N} \geq \kappa$ for all $a \leq m$. Krauth and Mézard conjectured the value of the limiting ratio $m_N(\kappa)/N$ for every margin, not only at $\kappa = 0$ [1]; the constant 0.833 is the zero-margin point of the conjectured curve $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$. At $\kappa = 0$ the conjecture is resolved: Ding and Sun [9] proved $\alpha_\star$ is a lower bound with positive probability, the sharp-threshold sequence of Xu [11] and Nakajima and Sun [21] upgrades positive probability to convergence in probability, Huang [10] proved the matching upper bound, and the numerical hypotheses of both proofs are certified [14]. Away from $\kappa = 0$ the upper half is Theorem 4. For the lower half, the replica-symmetric free energy is proved at small constraint density by Talagrand [6] and, for a wider class of activations, by Bolthausen, Nakajima, Sun, and Xu [15]; what has no analytic theorem to certify at present is a lower bound matching $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$. There are three partial results: a lemma showing that plain second moments fail at every margin, an embedded bound that gives capacity lower bounds for $\kappa < 0$, and a floating-point evaluation of the κ-dependent inputs of the Ding–Sun argument at the five margins.

8.1 Plain second moments fail at every margin

Write $\mathcal{Z} = \mathcal{Z}_{N,\kappa}$ for the number of $w \in \{-1,+1\}^N$ satisfying all $m = \lceil \alpha N \rceil$ constraints, and $\varpi_\rho(\kappa) = \mathbb{P}(X \geq \kappa,\, Y \geq \kappa)$ for (X, Y) bivariate standard Gaussian with correlation ρ.

Lemma 6. *For every $\kappa \in \mathbb{R}$ and $\alpha > 0$,*

$$\liminf_{N\to\infty} \frac{1}{N} \log \frac{\mathbb{E}[\mathcal{Z}^2]}{(\mathbb{E}\mathcal{Z})^2} \;\geq\; \delta(\alpha, \kappa) \;>\; 0.$$

Consequently the guarantee of the Paley–Zygmund bound, $\mathbb{P}(\mathcal{Z} > 0) \geq (\mathbb{E}\mathcal{Z})^2/\mathbb{E}[\mathcal{Z}^2]$, is at most $e^{-\delta N + o(N)}$, and no bound depending on $\mathbb{E}\mathcal{Z}$ and $\mathbb{E}[\mathcal{Z}^2]$ alone can certify more, since a distribution placing mass $(\mathbb{E}\mathcal{Z})^2/\mathbb{E}[\mathcal{Z}^2]$ at $\mathbb{E}[\mathcal{Z}^2]/\mathbb{E}\mathcal{Z}$ and the rest at zero matches both moments. For $\kappa \geq 0$ the same conclusion holds for every weighted count $\mathcal{Z}_f = \sum_w \prod_a f(\langle g_a, w\rangle/\sqrt{N})$ with $f \geq 0$ supported on $[\kappa, \infty)$ and $0 < \int f\varphi\, dx < \infty$.

Proof. $\mathbb{E}\mathcal{Z} = 2^N \Psi(\kappa)^m$ by independence over constraints. For a pair w, w' at overlap ρ the constraint fields are bivariate Gaussian with correlation ρ, so counting ordered pairs by Hamming distance k,

$$\mathbb{E}[\mathcal{Z}^2] = 2^N \sum_{k=0}^{N} \binom{N}{k} \varpi_{1-2k/N}(\kappa)^m.$$

Fix $\rho_0 \in (0,1)$, let $k^* = \lceil N(1-\rho_0)/2 \rceil$ and $\rho^* = 1 - 2k^*/N$. Keeping the single term k^* and using $\binom{N}{k} \geq e^{Nh(k/N)}/(N+1)$ with h the natural-log binary entropy ($h(p) = h(1-p)$, so the

exponent may be written with $(1+\rho_0)/2$),

$$\frac{1}{N}\log\frac{\mathbb{E}[\mathcal{Z}^2]}{(\mathbb{E}\mathcal{Z})^2} \geq \underbrace{h\Big(\tfrac{1+\rho_0}{2}\Big) - \log 2 + \alpha\big[\log\varpi_{\rho_0}(\kappa) - 2\log\Psi(\kappa)\big]}_{=:\,\zeta_{\alpha,\kappa}(\rho_0)} + O(N^{-1}\log N),$$

the error, of order $N^{-1}\log N$, collecting the binomial prefactor, the $|\rho^* - \rho_0| \leq 2/N$ continuity of $\rho \mapsto \log\varpi_\rho$ (differentiable, below), and $|m - \alpha N| \leq 1$. Now $\varpi_0 = \Psi(\kappa)^2$ and $h(1/2) = \log 2$ give $\zeta_{\alpha,\kappa}(0) = 0$. Reflecting the orthant to a joint CDF, $\varpi_\rho(\kappa) = \Phi_2(-\kappa,-\kappa;\rho)$, and Plackett's identity $\partial\Phi_2/\partial\rho = \varphi_2$ with the symmetry $\varphi_2(-\kappa,-\kappa;\rho) = \varphi_2(\kappa,\kappa;\rho)$ give $\partial\varpi_\rho/\partial\rho = \varphi_2(\kappa,\kappa;\rho)$ on $(-1,1)$; at $\rho = 0$ this is $\varphi(\kappa)^2$. Since $\frac{d}{d\rho}h(\frac{1+\rho}{2}) = \frac{1}{2}\log\frac{1-\rho}{1+\rho}$ vanishes at 0,

$$\zeta'_{\alpha,\kappa}(0) = \alpha\,\frac{\varphi(\kappa)^2}{\Psi(\kappa)^2} \;>\; 0,$$

so $\zeta_{\alpha,\kappa}(\rho_0) \geq \rho_0\,\zeta'_{\alpha,\kappa}(0)/2 > 0$ for all small $\rho_0 > 0$; fix such a ρ_0 and set $\delta = \zeta_{\alpha,\kappa}(\rho_0)$. For the weighted counts, the diagonal term of $\mathbb{E}[\mathcal{Z}_f^2]$ is $2^N\mathbb{E}[f(X)^2]^m$, so either $\mathbb{E}[\mathcal{Z}_f^2] = \infty$ and the claim is trivial, or $f \in L^2(\varphi\,dx)$ and Mehler's expansion gives $\mathbb{E}[f(X)f(Y)] = \sum_{j\geq 0}\rho^j\langle f, \mathrm{He}_j\rangle^2/j!$, whose ρ-derivative at 0 is $(\int xf\varphi\,dx)^2$; for $f \geq 0$ supported on $[\kappa,\infty)$ with $\kappa \geq 0$ the integrand $xf(x)\varphi(x)$ is nonnegative, and it vanishes almost everywhere only if f vanishes almost everywhere off the origin, which $0 < \int f\,d\Phi$ excludes; the argument then runs unchanged. □

The mechanism is the asymmetry: pairs of solutions at small positive overlap are exponentially favored over independent pairs at every margin, which is what the AMP-conditioned second moment of [9] is built to circumvent at $\kappa = 0$, and what any lower-bound proof must circumvent at every other margin. The zero-margin instance of this failure is classical (see the introduction of [9]); the content here is the uniform mechanism and the closure over nonnegative-margin weights. For $\kappa < 0$ the weighted closure genuinely fails, and profitably so: a window weight symmetric about the origin has zero linear Mehler coefficient, which is the next observation.

8.2 A capacity lower bound at negative margins

Proposition 7. *Let $\kappa < 0$ and let $\alpha_c^{\mathrm{sym}}(r) = \log 2/(-\log\mathbb{P}(|X| \leq r))$ denote the symmetric binary perceptron threshold at width r. For every $\alpha < \alpha_c^{\mathrm{sym}}(|\kappa|)$, with probability $1 - o(1)$ the margin-κ perceptron admits a solution, that is, $m_N(\kappa)/N \geq \alpha$.*

Proof. If $|\langle g_a, w\rangle|/\sqrt{N} \leq -\kappa$ for all a then in particular $\langle g_a, w\rangle/\sqrt{N} \geq \kappa$, so the symmetric solution set at width $|\kappa|$ embeds in the margin-κ solution set. The symmetric threshold is α_c^{sym} [16]; for Gaussian disorder the satisfiability side below it holds with high probability by Altschuler's critical-window theorem [19]. (The lognormal limit of Abbe, Li, and Sly [18] is proved for Rademacher disorder, and Perkins and Xu [17] treat the Gaussian case under a single-critical-point hypothesis, so neither alone covers the model here.) □

The bound should be read next to monotonicity. A solution at margin 0 is a solution at every $\kappa < 0$, so $m_N(\kappa) \geq m_N(0)$, and at $\kappa = 0$ the ratio $m_N(0)/N$ converges in probability to

$\alpha_\star(0) \approx 0.8330786$ (the lower half by [9] with the sharp-threshold transfer of [21], its numerical hypotheses certified in [14]). Hence for $\kappa < 0$

$$\frac{m_N(\kappa)}{N} \;\geq\; \max\bigl\{\alpha_\star(0),\, \alpha_c^{\mathrm{sym}}(|\kappa|)\bigr\} - o(1) \quad \text{whp.}$$

At the two certified negative margins monotonicity is the stronger input: the embedding gives 0.215 at $\kappa = -0.05$ and 0.655 at $\kappa = -0.45$, against the predicted 0.889 and 1.558. The embedding takes over only for $\kappa < -0.5757$, where $\alpha_c^{\mathrm{sym}}(|\kappa|)$ passes $\alpha_\star(0)$. Li, Schramm, and Zhou [23] prove lower bounds on the satisfiability threshold of the same one-sided perceptron at negative margin by a different route, with the sharpest statements in the $\kappa \to -\infty$ regime.

8.3 The Ding–Sun condition at general margin

The construction underlying the $\kappa = 0$ lower bound of [9] is written at general margin throughout their Section 2: their equations (34)–(48) define, for parameters $(\kappa_{\mathrm{all}}, \alpha_{\mathrm{all}})$, an explicit univariate function $S_{\kappa,\alpha}(\omega)$ on $[\omega_{\min}, 1]$ built from the fixed point $(q_\star, \psi_\star)$ (an entropy term through the two-spin measure $P_{H,D}$, a constraint term through the conditional Mills law φ_ξ, and a convex $\inf_s$ correction), and their Condition 1.2 is the statement $S_{0,\alpha_\star}(\omega) < 0$ for $\omega \notin \{0, 1\}$. The κ-analog of that hypothesis is therefore already defined in their own notation, and every κ-dependent ingredient it uses is an object this paper certifies: the fixed point, its uniqueness rectangle, and the crossing (Theorem 5 and the deep enclosures of Theorem 4).

We evaluated $S_{\kappa,\alpha_\star(\kappa)}$ in floating point (the driver `ds_condition.py` uses Gauss–Hermite and conditional Gauss–Legendre quadrature) at the five certified margins and at $\kappa = 0$, checking the six endpoint identities $H(0) = P(0) = A(0) = 0$, $H(1) = -H_\star$, $P(1) = -P_\star$, and $G_\star = H_\star + P_\star \approx 0$ (with $H_\star$, $P_\star$ the entropy and constraint halves of the free energy). The result is uniform (Figure 2): at every margin the curve is strictly negative off $\{0, 1\}$, at most $-5 \cdot 10^{-5}$ outside windows of half-width 0.02 around the two roots (inside them it climbs to its maxima at the roots, reaching $-1.6 \cdot 10^{-6}$ at the closest grid points), the maximum at $\omega = 0$ is degenerate exactly as at $\kappa = 0$, and the whole family collapses nearly onto a single shape, with $\omega_{\min}$ drifting from -0.441 at $\kappa = -0.45$ to -0.421 at $\kappa = 0.13$. These values are computed in floating point. Certifying $S_{\kappa,\alpha_\star} < 0$ off the roots is a one-variable problem of the type treated in Section 6.

What separates these verified inputs from a general-margin lower bound is the probabilistic body of [9]: the AMP-conditioned moment computation of their Sections 2–7, whose displays carry κ_{all} explicitly; by their Remark 1.5 the assumption $\kappa = 0$ enters only in a few steps, which they indicate. Extending that body to $\kappa \neq 0$ requires, beyond the certified inputs above: a priori bounds at margin (the upper one is free at every κ from the first moment, since $\mathbb{E}\mathcal{Z} \to 0$ exponentially above the annealed threshold $-\log 2/\log \Psi(\kappa)$; for $\kappa < 0$ the lower one is the monotonicity bound above), the state-evolution inputs (generic in the nonlinearity, hence in κ), and the sharp-threshold transfer of [21] if convergence in probability rather than positive probability is wanted.

9 Checking the computation

The certificates are checked in five ways.

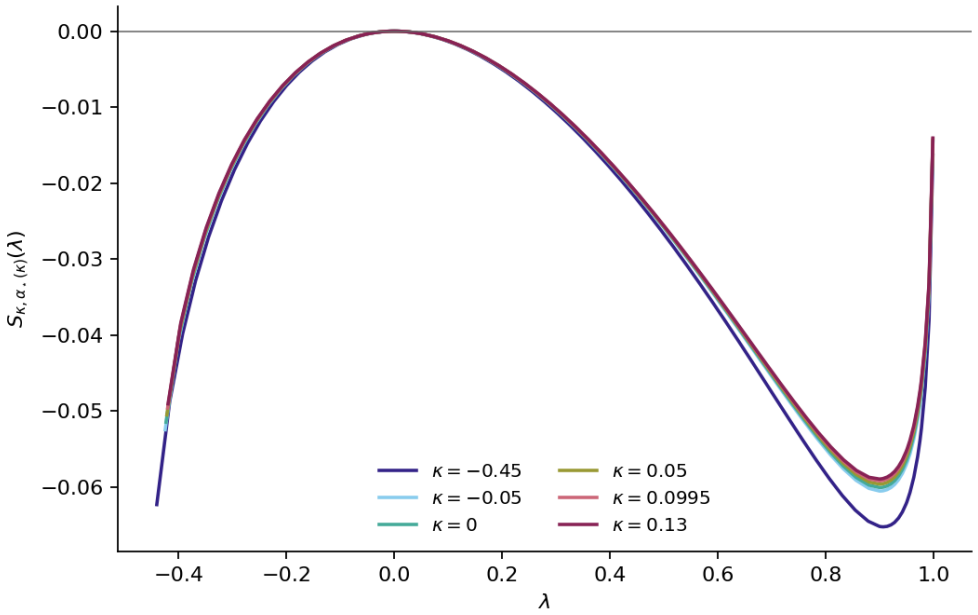


Figure 2: The general-margin Ding–Sun lower-bound condition, evaluated at the five certified margins and $\kappa = 0$: the univariate function $S_{\kappa,\alpha_\star(\kappa)}$ of their equation (48), whose nonpositivity off $\{0, 1\}$ is the numerical hypothesis of their second-moment argument. All six curves are negative off the two roots and nearly coincide.

Ball-arithmetic soundness by construction. Every quantity is an arb ball containing the true value; a PASS is a ball comparison true only when certain. The primitives (monotone endpoint evaluations, mean-value cells, correlated integrands, tail bounds) are the same as in [14].

Symbolic verification of every identity. The stationarity and $\partial R/\partial q$ identities, the ℓ reformulation (identity, monotonicity, bound), the Nakajima closed form, the general-margin additions to the constraint kernels, and the Bregman collapse are checked in computer algebra.

Values at $\kappa = 0$. Every computation reproduces the zero-margin values: the fixed-point rectangle, Huang's AMP and ℓ constants, his C_j and $\det \mathcal{H}$ intervals; the quadrature agrees digit for digit with that of [14] at test points.

Exact artifacts and replay. The two-variable chain's certificates carry every sign-critical quantity as outward-rounded decimal packets in canonical JSON, with SHA-256 source and payload binding and atomic no-clobber publication; the stage-2 artifact binds the hash of the Region-I manifest it consumed. Some schedule-geometry fields are ordinary JSON floats; they parameterize display and tiling bookkeeping, not the inequalities. The strip-slab and rectangle files record their enclosures as display strings, and their sign claims are not part of the kernel layer. A dependency-free portable checker re-verifies the connection layer from the JSON artifacts alone: the envelope hashes, the stage-2-to-Region-I bindings, the star-interior chain recomputed outward in exact rationals, and the tilings within each serialized chain. It also binds each recorded leaf value to the inequality it stands for (every cell or band marked

passing must carry a nonpositive worst-case $\mathcal{S}_\star$ and no subcell failure), so a flipped flag or a mismarked positive value is caught rather than trusted (the transcendental re-evaluation itself remains the ball-arithmetic layer's job). The checker also enforces two global completeness clauses on the band geometry: the innermost ring must close the full circle as a single seam-exact run, and each level's angular support must sit inside the previous level's, which together make every direction's radial chain contiguous out to the radius where its support ends; a deliberately corrupted manifest with all hashes consistently rebound fails exactly this check. The outermost band level is bound to the star radius recorded in the same manifest, which is the reach the stage-2 containment uses and binds by hash. The Lean files prove the tiling of each chain separately; the global completeness clauses are checked by the Python checker only.

A second proof system. The exact combinatorial and algebraic layer of the certificate chain (the star-interior inequality chain and the positivity of its perturbation determinant from the serialized packets, the definiteness of the Loewner majorants, and the gap-free tilings of the Region II and stage-2 grids and the Region-I band schedule) is re-stated over the integers and kernel-checked in Lean 4 (core library only, checked with v4.35.0), following the zero-margin release: per-margin generated files whose kernel-decided theorems cover the 1404-band radius chain and its angular runs, both grid tilings, and the star-interior packet chain, with the Loewner-majorant family at all five margins. The extraction is mirrored in exact rational arithmetic so an extraction bug cannot silently weaken the Lean claims, and a mutation battery (negating one certificate integer per file) rejects every mutant. The slab-level sign claims are not part of this layer: the strip manifests carry display strings rather than exact packets. This layer does not formalize the analytic mathematics; it removes the Python layer from the trusted base for the parts a kernel can decide.

10 What the curve says about learning

For binary weights the Euclidean norm is fixed at $\sqrt{N}$, so a margin constraint is exactly a robustness certificate: if $y_a\langle w, x_a\rangle/\sqrt{N} \geq \kappa$ then the label y_a is invariant under every perturbation of x_a of Euclidean norm below κ. With centrally symmetric i.i.d. designs and independent labels, label folding makes the robust-interpolation event identical to the satisfiability event studied here, so $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ is the predicted threshold for how many random labels per parameter a one-bit-per-parameter linear classifier can memorize with prescribed robustness radius. The certified $\kappa = 0.05$ bound, for instance, says such a classifier cannot robustly store more than 0.781075 random labels per parameter at that radius, with the guarantee holding against a worst-case adversary in feature space.

Reading the whole curve quantitatively (`results/robustness_price.csv`): on the certified strip the threshold decays log-linearly at rate 1.39 per unit margin, so robust storage capacity halves for every 0.50 of demanded feature-space radius, and the decay continues smoothly beyond (a factor 4.8 from $\kappa = 0$ to 1.5). The efficiency of binary relative to real-valued weights *rises* with the demanded robustness: $\alpha_\star/\alpha_{\text{spherical}}$ grows from 0.417 at $\kappa = 0$ to 0.556 at $\kappa = 1.5$, so one-bit parameters give up proportionally less storage precisely where the robustness requirement is stiffest. On the relaxed side ($\kappa < 0$, tolerating margin violations up to $|\kappa|$) capacity grows toward the annealed bound (the ratio reaches 0.996 by $\kappa = -2$) and the solution space measurably approaches the replica-symmetry-breaking regime (the weak Hessian eigenvalue of the two-variable function degrades threefold by $\kappa = -1.5$), which is where the replica-symmetric prediction itself should eventually fail. The replica-

symmetric cavity picture also predicts the margin distribution *among* solutions: conditionally on the quenched component $\sqrt{q}\,Z$ of a constraint's field, the field on a typical solution is $N(\sqrt{q}\,Z,\,1-q)$ truncated to $[\kappa,\infty)$, so the gap density across constraints is the mixture $p(h) = \mathbb{E}_Z[\varphi_{1-q}(h-\sqrt{q}\,Z)\,\mathbf{1}\{h \geq \kappa\}/\Psi(u(Z))]$. Computed along the branch at $\kappa = 0.05$ (a float diagnostic, `margin_distribution.py`), the mean gap above the demanded margin compresses from 0.70 at $\alpha = \frac{1}{2}\alpha_\star$ to 0.59 at $\alpha_\star$: solutions are squeezed against the constraint boundary as storage saturates, which is the quantity a margin-type generalization argument would consume, and a natural next target for the certified machinery. These are statements about information-theoretic storage, not about algorithms: for the Ising perceptron the known efficient algorithms stall far below $\alpha_\star$, and the margin curve gives the ceiling against which that algorithmic gap should be measured at every κ. Limits of the reading: nothing here concerns generalization on structured data, correlated features, or hidden layers; κ is a feature-space radius, and translating it to input space requires a Lipschitz bound on the feature map.

The algorithmic gap the curve frames is directly measurable at moderate size. A population annealer (hinge energy on violated margins, geometric schedule matched to the $2/\sqrt{N}$ energy scale; `finite_size_experiment.py`) trained $N = 101$ instances across α at $\kappa \in \{0, 0.05, 0.1\}$. The densities at which half of its runs succeed fall in the order of κ and sit about a tenth of $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ below it at this budget, while scattered successes persist to the bound itself: at $\kappa = 0.1$ the last appear at $\alpha \approx 0.73$, essentially at $\alpha_\star$, and none beyond. The solutions the annealer does find are atypical in exactly the direction the clustering picture predicts: at low load their mean gap above κ tracks the typical-solution law $p(h)$, while near the half-success density it holds around 0.65–0.70 as the typical mean descends; the algorithm reaches the wide, over-margined minority. At $N = 201$ under the same per-spin budget the success curves sharpen and shift left, so what the annealer traces is a budget-dependent lower envelope of the true algorithmic threshold, whose location and the clustering barrier behind it are studied in [20, 23] on the closely related symmetric and asymmetric binary perceptrons; the found-solution histograms meanwhile track the derived $p(h)$ closely at moderate load and deform toward mid-gaps near the half-success density. Both effects are schedule-dependent observations, not thresholds; the certified curve is what they are measured against. Within each size and budget the half-success density sits at a κ-independent fraction of $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$ (0.90 at $N = 101$ down to 0.50 at $N = 801$, flat across margins to better than one percent at the largest sizes), so the demanded margin costs the algorithm the same relative capacity it costs the storage bound (Figure 3). At fixed sweeps per spin the fraction falls with N (0.90, 0.75, 0.69, 0.63, 0.50 at $N = 101$, 201, 301, 401, 801), close to a fixed loss of 0.13 per doubling over the measured range; holding a constant fraction of capacity requires superlinearly growing total work. On the budget axis at $N = 201$ the fraction climbs 0.75, 0.79, 0.86 as the budget quadruples twice, but a further quadrupling to 25,600 sweeps per spin gains only 0.02 (0.876): the fixed gain per quadrupling stops at 6,400, and the half-success density saturates near 0.88 of capacity at this size over the measured range.

The margin price also depends on the weight alphabet. Solving the replica-symmetric system for ternary weights $\{-1, 0, +1\}$ with a self-overlap order parameter (`exploration/ternary_km.py`, anchored by reproducing the binary $\alpha_\star(0) = 0.8330786$ to the certified digits) gives $\alpha_\star^{\mathrm{tern}}(0) = 1.17448$ against an annealed bound of $\log_2 3$, with 1.07951 at $\kappa = 0.05$ and 0.99483 at $\kappa = 0.1$. Per weight *state* the richer alphabet stores more; per weight *bit* it stores less: 0.741 against the binary 0.833 constraints per bit at $\kappa = 0$, and the gap widens monotonically with margin (0.100 at $\kappa = 0.05$, 0.105 at 0.1). At this level of the theory, binary remains

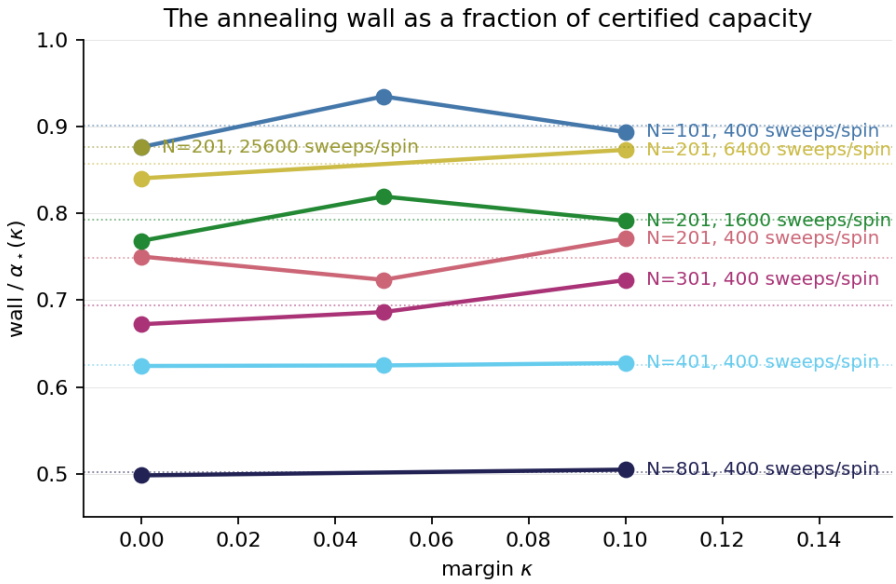


Figure 3: The half-success density of the annealer as a fraction of the predicted capacity $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$, across size–budget pairs. Within each run the fraction is flat in κ to a few percent, while its level depends on both size and budget.

the bit-efficient quantization for robust storage. The full eight-point curve (Figure 4, κ up to 0.35) makes this a statement about the whole margin range rather than three samples: per stored bit the binary curve sits above the ternary one everywhere, the absolute gap saturating near 0.11 constraints per bit above $\kappa \approx 0.2$ while the relative advantage grows from 12 to 26 percent, since both capacities fall with margin.

11 Scope and further directions

The machinery is not specific to the binary prior or to this constraint law, and the natural next studies are ordered by how much of it they reuse.

The strip, quantified. The four-piece certificate of Section 6 accepts a κ ball in place of a point, but run on slab hulls with the present evaluator it fails for the reasons measured in Section 7.1. An interval theorem needs two ingredients that are not in this paper: a certified κ-derivative for each certificate family, and quadratic control with explicit remainder bounds on the annulus between the star and the fat far-field cells. Given those, an adaptive κ-subdivision driven by the certified margins would turn Theorem 4 into a statement on the whole strip.

Other margins of the same family. The certified pipeline applies wherever the continuation reaches: positive margins to $\kappa \approx 1.15$ (past which the fixed-tilt center certificate must re-optimize the tilt, as measured in Section 5.1), and negative margins until replica-symmetry breaking territory, where the natural target is the approach (the degradation of the weak eigenvalue and of the ℓ_0 margin) rather than the condition.

Other priors and activations. The moment-coordinate reduction needs only that the profile enter through finitely many moments of a log-concave base pair; replacing $\{-1, +1\}$ by a

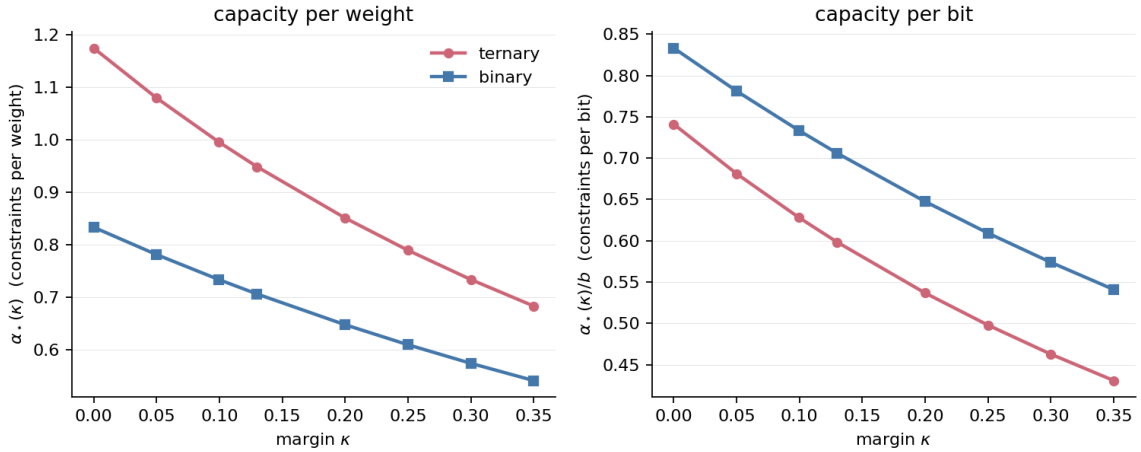


Figure 4: Replica-symmetric capacity of ternary against binary weights, per weight (left) and per stored bit (right, dividing by $\log_2 3$ and 1). The order reverses: the richer prior stores more per weight and less per bit, at every computed margin.

bounded discrete prior changes Φ and the moment body but not the architecture. The spherical perceptron at margin (Gardner's curve, shown for context in Figure 1) has simpler convexity structure and would serve as a validation target where exact answers are classical.

Teacher–student and structured labels. The planted version replaces the annealed constraint law by a tilted one; the cavity argument and the two-variable function have direct analogues, and the certified-slab design (per-slab rectangles, located boxes, deep bisection) transfers whenever the fixed-point system does.

Toward learning theory. Two quantitative bridges seem within reach of exactly this machinery: certified upper bounds along capacity curves for one-bit compressed classifiers (the κ-robust memorization ceiling above, made uniform over the strip), and certified bounds on the margin distribution achievable at a given $\alpha < \alpha_\star(\kappa)$, which is the object that connects storage geometry to generalization bounds of the classical margin type.

The lower bound. Ding and Sun's conditioned second-moment argument is carried out at $\kappa = 0$ only, and the bound of Section 8 lies far below $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$; the threshold at $\kappa \neq 0$ is not determined here.

Notation

The last column gives the section where the symbol is defined. Symbols used only inside one proof are not listed.

Symbol	Meaning	Section
N	number of binary weights	1
w	weight vector in $\{-1,+1\}^N$	1
g_a	a-th pattern, a standard Gaussian vector in $\mathbb{R}^N$	1
m	number of patterns, $m = \lceil \alpha N \rceil$	1

Symbol	Meaning	Section
α	pattern density m/N	1
κ	margin	1
$\varphi,\ \Psi$	standard Gaussian density and upper tail	2
E	inverse Mills ratio φ/Ψ	2
Z	standard Gaussian variable	2
$u(z;q,\kappa)$	$(\kappa-\sqrt{q}\,z)/\sqrt{1-q}$	2
$q,\ \psi$	the two order parameters	2
$P,\ R$	the two halves of the fixed-point map, (1)	2
G	replica-symmetric free energy, (2)	2
$G_\star(\alpha)$	G along the fixed-point branch	2
$\alpha_\star(\kappa)$	the zero of $G_\star$; the predicted capacity	2
$(q_\star,\psi_\star)$	the fixed-point branch as a function of α	2
(q_0,ψ_0)	the fixed point at $\alpha_\star(\kappa)$	2
$\ell(\hat{z}),\ \ell_0$	the local-concavity function of Condition 3 and its minimum	4.1
$\mu(\hat{z})$	$\mathbb{E}[(\hat{z}+\cosh^2(\sqrt{\psi_0}Z))^{-1}]$	4.1
$\tau,\ A,\ \beta$	$E'(u)$, $1-q_0$ and $\mu(\hat{z})-A$ in the formula for ℓ	4.1
$\mathcal{H}$	Hessian of Huang's first-moment functional at its maximizer	5.1
η	shifted cavity variable $E\big((\kappa-\hat{H})/\sqrt{1-q_0}\big)/\sqrt{1-q_0}$	5.1
$\dot{H},\ \hat{H}$	independent Gaussians of variances ψ_0 and q_0	5.2
M	$\tanh\dot{H}$	5.2
Λ	a profile, a function of $(\dot{H},M)$ with values in $[-1,1]$	5.2
$a=(a_1,a_2)$	the moments $(\mathbb{E}[\dot{H}\Lambda],\mathbb{E}[M\Lambda])$	5.2
K	the moment body, the set of attainable a	5.2
$\mathcal{S}(\Lambda,s)$	Huang's two-variable function at tilt s	5.2
$\mathcal{S}_\star(\lambda_1,\lambda_2)$	$\inf_{s\geq 0}\mathcal{S}(\tanh(\lambda_1\dot{H}+\lambda_2 M),s)$	5.2
$\lambda,\ b$	dual points in $\mathbb{R}^2$	5.2
$\Phi(b)$	$\mathbb{E}\log 2\cosh(b_1\dot{H}+b_2M)$	5.2
$H(a)$	entropy term as a function of the moments	5.2
$a^\star$	the maximizer $(\psi_0(1-q_0),q_0)$	5.2
s_0	the optimal tilt $\sqrt{1-q_0}$ at $a^\star$	5.2
$\mathcal{F}(a,s)$	$\mathcal{S}(\cdot,s)$ written in moment coordinates	6
$v,\ c,\ t$	ray direction, tilt slope and distance along the ray	6
$\chi_{v,c}(t)$	$\mathcal{F}(a^\star+tv,\ s_0+ct)$	6
Δ	$(\lambda_1-1)\dot{H}+\lambda_2 M$ in the Bregman integrand	6
$V,\ \sigma$	cavity argument and $E(V)-V$	Lemma 3
B	interval majorant of $\nabla^2\Phi$ on a Region I band	7
$m_N(\kappa)$	largest m for which a solution exists	8
$S_{\kappa,\alpha}(\omega)$	Ding and Sun's univariate function on $[\omega_{\min},1]$	8

Acknowledgements and funding

The author acknowledges support from the European Research Council under the European Union's Horizon Europe program (grant 101041711), the Simons Foundation, Heights Labs, Convex Nexus Capital, and Israel Science Foundation grants 2258/19 and 4101/25. Computational resources were provided in part by Google Cloud through its education credits program (credit 530550103).

Declaration of competing interest

The author holds equity in Heights Labs and in Convex Nexus Capital and has a management role at Convex Nexus Capital.

Declaration of generative AI and AI-assisted technologies

The mathematics, the software, the certificates and the drafting of this paper were done by AI agents, Claude (Anthropic) and Codex (OpenAI), working through the shared memory of the Math Brain project: its code and tests [24], the framework it runs on [26] and its description [25]. The author set the objective, supervised the runs, reviewed the mathematics and accepts responsibility for the paper.

Data availability

No data were used. The verification programs, certificates and raw records are available at `https://github.com/yspennstate/ising-perceptron-margin/tree/v2.0`.

The paper is part of the Math Brain project [24].

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